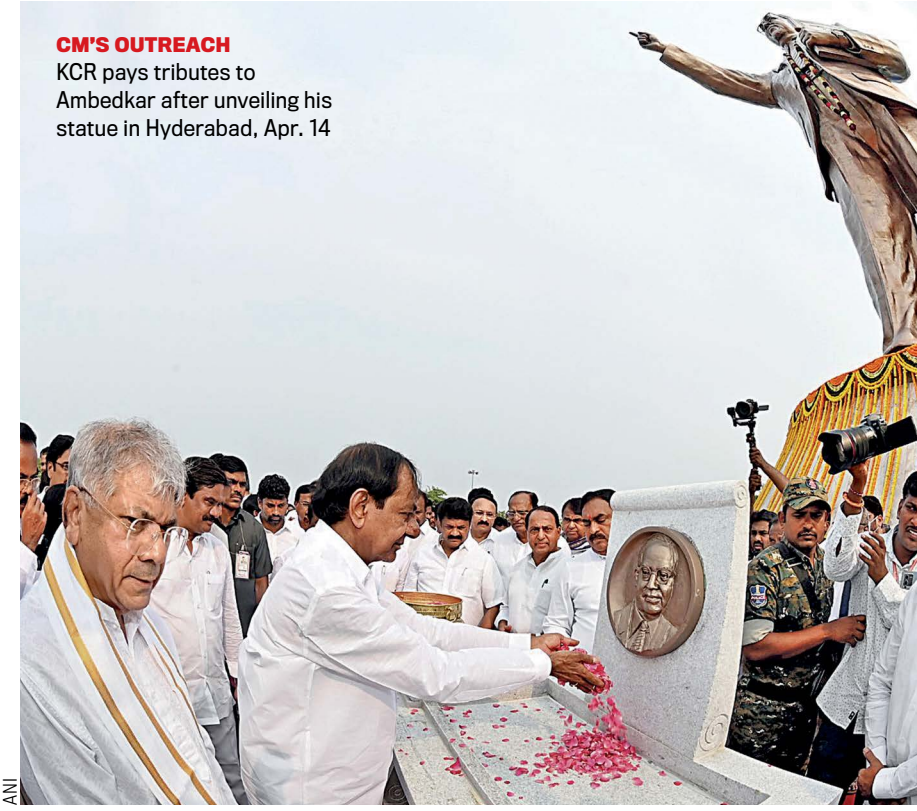
been campaigning determinedly against the privatisation of the Vizag Steel Plant; the move seen as their bid to cash in on an emotive issue.

FOCUS ON FARMERS

The party's electoral strategy hinges on showcasing its "Telangana model" of pro-farmer and development initiatives to make inroads into other states. KCR's new slogan "*Ab Ki Bar Kisan Sarkar*" says it all. "Our vote is a powerful weapon that should be exercised judiciously," is his common refrain to groups of farmers calling on him from other states ever since he held a meeting with farm union leaders from across the country in August last year. In Maharashtra, as he holds one rally after the other, KCR highlights his government's schemes while decrying the agrarian crisis, especially water woes and farmers' suicides, in the western state. The template is being religiously followed, be it at his first two rallies held in Nanded (one of the backward and predominantly agrarian districts of the Marathwada region) on February 5 and March 26, or at the recent one in Aurangabad on April 24.

There are also other facets of the Telangana model that the BRS and its leaders like to tout. So how has the KCR regime been performing on the economic and development front? "The per capita income in Telangana has increased from Rs 1.24 lakh in 2014-15 to Rs 3.17 lakh in 2022-23, surpassing all other states," claims BRS working president and KCR's son K.T. Rama Rao, or KTR. "This performance is despite an inimical Union government." The figures are based on the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation data covering 16 states released in March. KTR, who is also a cabinet minister holding the charge of industries, IT and municipal administration, further shares that Telangana is among the top contributing states to India's GDP and third in the Ease of Doing Business.



ANI

CM'S OUTREACH
KCR pays tributes to Ambedkar after unveiling his statue in Hyderabad, Apr. 14

THE BRS ELECTORAL STRATEGY HINGES ON SHOWCASING ITS 'TELANGANA MODEL' OF PRO-FARMER AND DEVELOPMENT INITIATIVES TO MAKE INROADS INTO OTHER STATES

"It is the first state to provide drinking water to all homes, build the world's largest lift irrigation project [in Kaleshwaram] and has the best rural development model in the country with 100 per cent Open Defecation Free villages. Be it agriculture or technology the state is right at the top," he says. During the nine years of BRS rule, adds Harish Rao, each village in Telangana has received more than Rs 100 crore development funds in various forms.

ELECTION-YEAR SOPS

The clock ticking on his plans, KCR is eager to implement the newly announced populist schemes vigorously and speed up the old ones. The Dalit Bandhu scheme, which was launched in 2021 and has provided Rs 10 lakh each for starting a business to 1,100 Scheduled Caste families in the Huzurabad assembly segment, is to be extended to 130,000 beneficiaries across the state. As part of his national ambitions, KCR also talks of taking the scheme to Dalits across India, covering 2.5 million families each year, "after coming to power at the Centre".

Then, there are plans to extend the Rythu Bandhu scheme to 1.5 million tenant farmers and farm labourers. This agriculture investment support scheme provides Rs 10,000 aid an acre per year to farmers. The ongoing Kanti